

# Diabetes Overview

## What is Diabetes?

Diabetes is a chronic disease in which blood glucose levels remain higher than normal because the body does not produce enough insulin or cannot use it effectively.

## Types

Type 1: autoimmune destruction of insulin-producing cells. Type 2: insulin resistance and reduced insulin production. Gestational diabetes occurs during pregnancy.

## Symptoms

Frequent urination, excessive thirst, increased hunger, fatigue, blurred vision, slow wound healing, unexplained weight loss.

## Risk Factors

Family history, obesity, physical inactivity, unhealthy diet, age, high blood pressure.

## Diagnosis

Fasting plasma glucose, HbA1c, oral glucose tolerance test, random plasma glucose.

## Management

Healthy diet, regular exercise, weight management, prescribed medication or insulin, routine blood sugar monitoring.

## Complications

Heart disease, stroke, kidney disease, nerve damage, eye disease, foot problems.

## Prevention

Maintain healthy weight, exercise 150 minutes/week, balanced diet, avoid smoking, regular health checkups.